

persuades Martins on moral grounds to help him trap Lime even if Anna is not saved.

Anna warns Lime of the trap, and he tries to escape through the sewers. The climax, a masterful symphony of action beneath the Viennese streets, is one of the most thrilling moments in cinema.

Casting Welles

That the movie turned out as it did is due largely to the determination of the director Carol Reed. Producer David O. Selznick had wanted suave British actor Noel Coward to play Harry Lime, but Reed insisted on Orson Welles. The influence of

Welles can be seen not just in his acting but in the dramatic film noir shooting style, which clearly owes a lot to Welles's own movies *Citizen Kane* (1941) and *The Lady from Shanghai* (1947).

For the final chase through the sewers of Vienna, scenes were shot partly on location and partly on studio sets. Reed brilliantly edited together the long, empty caverns of the sewers, with their glistening bricks and sudden shafts of light, and the echoing footsteps and close-ups of Lime's sweaty face glistening like the bricks, eyes darting this way and that as he searches for a way out.

As ever-growing teams of police chase Lime through the sewers, only the running water and the cops' echoing calls in German can be heard. The sense of panic rises as Lime flees like a rat.

Both Selznick and Greene had wanted an upbeat ending, but Reed insisted on keeping it bleak. Greene later admitted Reed had been right.

Clever use of shadows heightens the sense of menace in the dark streets of war-ravaged Vienna. The noir style is strongly reminiscent of Orson Welles's own movies, but Welles later insisted that he had taken no direct role in the movie's direction or editing.

